

ALPHA FLIGHT

Canada's foremost Super Hero team



The Alpha Flight team roar into action.

Conceived as the Canadian government's answer to the recent spate of superhuman activity within the United States, Alpha Flight was the brainchild of James MacDonald Hudson, soon to be known first as Vindicator, then as GUARDIAN.

Inspired by the FANTASTIC FOUR, Hudson and his wife Heather convinced the

Canadian government to found Department H, which would be tasked with assembling a team of superhumans indigenous to the Great White North.

ALPHA FLIGHT (2006)

1 Centennial 2 Sasquatch
3 Yukon Jack 4 Puck II
5 Nemesis 6 Major Mapleleaf

WANTED: A LEADER

The project was implemented using a three-tiered training system: new recruits or those whose powers proved unstable would be assigned to Gamma Flight. Those whose command of their abilities required further training formed the basis of Beta Flight. The front line, the active members whose job it would be to rout any superhuman threats to the nation, were Alpha Flight.

Hudson intended that the man known as Logan (see WOLVERINE) or WEAPON X would lead Alpha Flight.

However, that task fell to Hudson himself when Logan was recruited by PROFESSOR X to become a member of his X-MEN team. Alpha Flight endured a rocky relationship with the Canadian government.

While the Beta and Gamma Flight units produced some heroes for Alpha Flight—like Puck—the programs also formed the nucleus of the sinister OMEGA FLIGHT team. Alpha Flight soldiered on, despite several roster changes, loyal to protecting their homeland. When the alien Plodex abducted the rest of Alpha Flight, SASQUATCH assembled a new, oddball squad that included the 97-year-old Centennial, Major Mapleleaf, the deadly Nemesis, Puck II (Puck's daughter), and the mysterious Yukon Jack. In the aftermath of M-DAY, a man known as the Collective blazed across Canada, bursting with the energy of all the mutant powers lost on that day. A hastily assembled Alpha Flight team—consisting of GUARDIAN, Major Mapleleaf, both Pucks, Sasquatch, SHAMAN, and VINDICATOR—tried to stop him and was slaughtered. Only Sasquatch is known to have survived, and he soon after put together a new team of heroes called, ironically, Omega Flight. **TB, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Uncanny X-Men* #120–121

Alpha Flight ambushes the X-Men in an attempt to recover the AWOL Wolverine for the Canadian government.

• *Alpha Flight* #12

Guardian is seemingly killed during Alpha's battle with Omega Flight.

• *Alpha Flight Vol. 3* #1–6

With the real Alpha Flight missing, Sasquatch assembles a new team of off-beat heroes.

FACTFILE

ORIGINAL MEMBERS

GUARDIAN

Electromagnetic battlesuit allows him to fly, surrounds him with a powerful force-field, and permits him to throw bolts of electromagnetic force.

VINDICATOR

Geothermic battlesuit allows her to fly, cause the earth to erupt volcanically, and blast a lavalike substance from her hands.

SHAMAN

Withdraws needed objects from enchanted medicine pouch.

SASQUATCH

Superhuman strength and imperviousness to harm.

PUCK

Trained fighter, skilled acrobat.

SNOWBIRD

Transforms into various Canadian animal forms.

BASE

Tamarind Island, British Columbia

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men #120
(April 1979)



The original team battled Wendigo and other villains in a story that featured Canadian PM Pierre Trudeau!